WHEELER
FOOD SAFETY SERVICES

Magnet Inspection & Cleaning Log

Routine checks for grate, drawer, plate, tube, and in-line magnets

Company / site: _____ Area / line: _____ Inspection frequency (per plan): _____ Week of / page: _____

Date	Time	Magnet ID / location	Housing, tubes & welds intact? (Y / N)	Seals & covers OK? (Y / N)	Metal captured? (None / Fines / Pieces)	Describe what was captured (and amount)	Cleaned? (Y / N)	Re-installed correctly? (Y / N)	Corrective action (ref # if any)	Initials	Verified by (QA / supv.)

Act on what you find: a cracked tube or housing, a damaged seal, or a magnet that won't seat correctly means take it out of service and tell QA. Pieces of metal (not just fines), or more than usual, mean find the source upstream: a worn part, broken screen, or missing hardware.

Strength testing (pull test or gauss readings) is done on a separate schedule, at least once a year, against your acceptance limit. Record those results on a magnet validation report, not this log.

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How to Inspect and Clean Food Plant Magnets

A plant guide for operators and QA. Follow your own procedures and the magnet manufacturer's instructions.

Safety first

- Rare earth magnets are **very strong**. Keep fingers clear of pinch points, and handle tubes and drawers with care.
- Keep magnets away from people with **pacemakers or other medical implants**, and from phones, cards, and electronics.
- Follow lockout / tagout and stop product flow before removing a magnet.

How to inspect and clean

1. **Stop product flow** and remove or open the magnet per your procedure.
2. **Look at what it caught** before cleaning: fines, flakes, or pieces? How much? Record it.
3. **Inspect** the tubes, plates, housing, welds, and seals for cracks, dents, wear, or gaps that could let product bypass the magnet.
4. **Clean** it with the method in your procedure (wipe-off, sleeve, or easy-clean mechanism), away from product, so captured metal can't fall back in.
5. **Dispose of the captured metal** safely, or bag it for investigation.
6. **Re-install** the magnet correctly: every tube or plate in place and fully seated.
7. Record the check on the log and initial it.

When to check

- At the frequency in your plan. Many plants check **every shift or every day**, more often for high-volume or high-risk lines.
- **After any upset**: equipment breakdown, a screen failure, or metal found downstream.
- **After maintenance** on upstream equipment.

Build-up on a magnet reduces how well it catches metal, so clean before it gets heavy.

What captured metal tells you

- **Fine ferrous dust** in small amounts can be normal for some ingredients.
- **More than usual**, or **pieces, flakes, or wire**, point to a problem upstream: worn blades or screens, broken parts, or missing hardware.
- Trend what you find. A change is often the first sign of equipment wear.

Inspection vs. validation

Inspection and cleaning (this log) keep the magnet working day to day. **Validation** proves it is still strong enough: pull testing at defined points on every tube, against your acceptance limit, at least once a year.

Need a magnet validation? Wheeler Food Safety validates magnets, metal detectors, and X-ray systems across Utah: wheelerfs.com · (385) 201-5609.

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